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AML Transaction Screening & Monitoring

Note

- The AML integration is a premium feature that requires an additional purchase. Reach out to your Customer Success Manager if you do not have an agreement with an AML provider or you need help enabling the feature.
- Fireblocks is a US-based company and, as such, is subject to the [Office of Foreign Assets Control \(OFAC\)](#) sanctions and restrictions. Therefore, we are obligated to block all [restricted addresses under OFAC](#) on our system.

Overview

Since privacy is a key principle of blockchain technology, transactions on the blockchain do not contain any information about the people or organizations involved. However, criminals may try to use this anonymity to hide illicit fund transfers. To prevent funds from being sent to criminals or sanctioned parties, regulators in many jurisdictions have begun mandating the collection of personal data for users transacting on the blockchain.

The Fireblocks AML feature allows you to automate real-time monitoring of your crypto transactions in order to ensure compliance with Anti-Money Laundering/Counter Financing of Terrorism (AML/CFT) regulations, prevent interactions with sanctioned entities, and identify customer behavior. You can integrate your Fireblocks account with Chainalysis or Elliptic, our third-party transaction monitoring providers, to retrieve AML/CFT information on your incoming and outgoing transactions. You can also implement your own custom screening logic for AML providers that are not natively supported.

Note

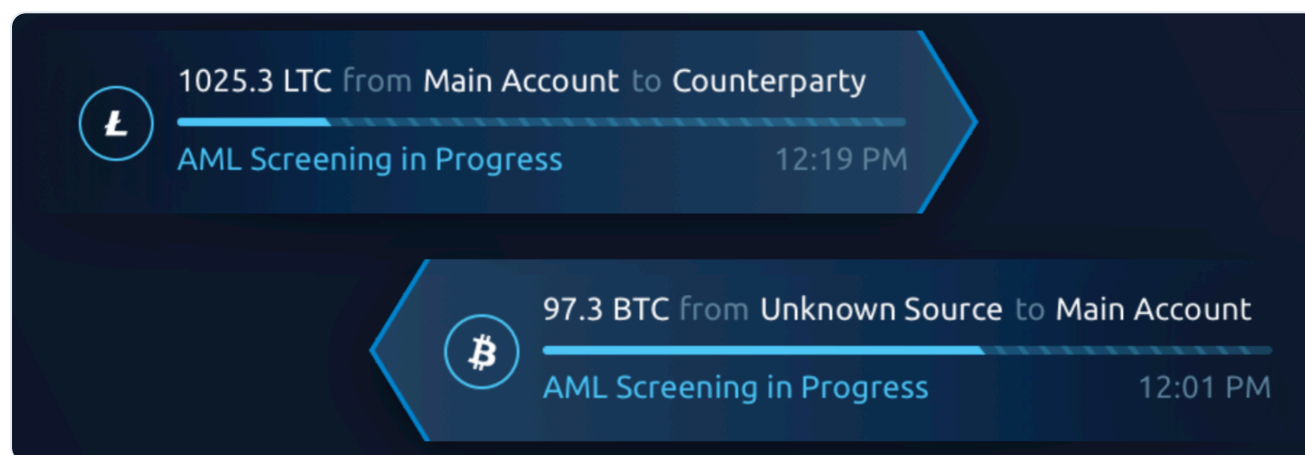
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based on the policy you create. The provider then returns a risk profile based on the transaction details (including addresses). You can approve, reject, or receive alerts for transactions in response to the provided risk information.

You, the transaction owner, are responsible for compliance reporting. Fireblocks and the AML provider make reporting easy with auditable risk information available for export. In the event of a risky transaction in a jurisdiction that requires reporting, your compliance officer will need to file any regulatory requirements with the appropriate authorities.



Benefits of AML Transaction Screening

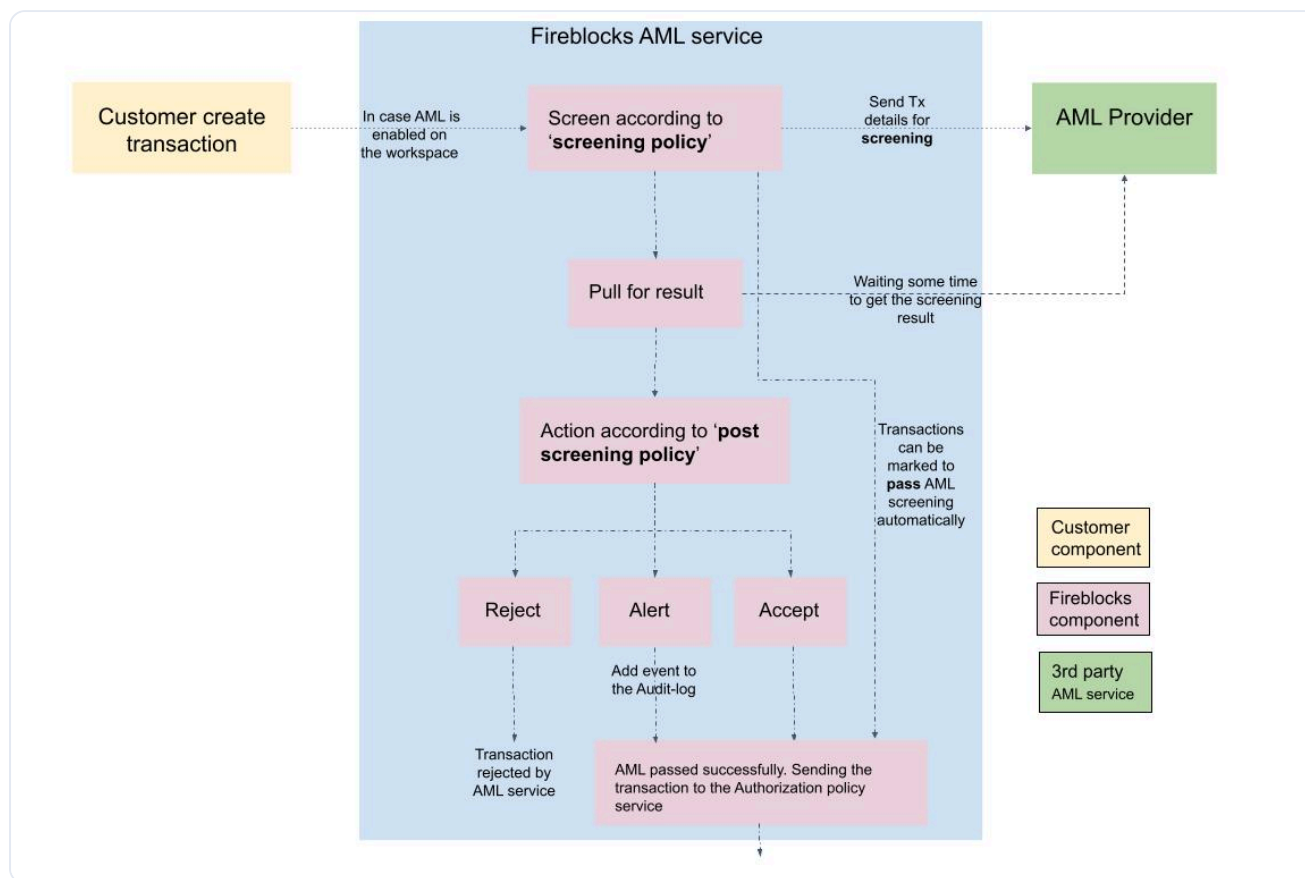
- Set AML policies according to your compliance strategy
- Continuously monitor and stay up-to-date on risk information (AML/CFT and sanctions risk)
- Automatically register transactions with your transaction monitoring provider
- Automatically freeze risky inbound transactions
- Manually freeze and unfreeze transactions via the API
- Automatically prevent risky outbound transactions
- View risk information on your mobile device prior to authorizing outbound transactions
- Automatically associate customers with transactions using User IDs (optional)
- Access auditable risk information via the UI and API
- View and export auditable risk information for compliance and regulatory purposes

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1. You initiate a transaction in your Fireblocks workspace.
2. The transaction passes through your AML Transaction Screening Policy to determine whether it should then be sent to your AML provider for screening.
3. If the transaction should be screened according to your policy, Fireblocks sends the transaction's details to the provider to receive the transaction's risk information and to be registered for further monitoring. Fireblocks shares the following transaction information with your AML provider:
 - Asset
 - Amount
 - Origin address
 - Beneficiary address
 - Blockchain hash
4. Your AML provider determines the transaction's risk score and sends the result to your Fireblocks workspace. [Learn how Fireblocks handles outgoing transactions when risk scores are not available immediately.](#)
5. The integration approves or rejects the transaction based on its risk information and your Post-Screening Policy.

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If an outgoing transaction contains multiple destinations, each destination is screened individually. However, the entire transaction is approved or rejected based on the destination with the highest risk score. For example, if one destination receives a risk score that would be rejected based on your Post-Screening Policy, then the entire transaction is rejected.

```
graph TD
    subgraph Fireblocks_AML_service [Fireblocks AML service]
        direction TB
        A[Scan the blockchain for inbound transactions to Fireblocks addresses] -- "In case AML is enabled on the workspace" --> B[Screen according to 'screening policy']
        B --> C[Pull for result]
        C --> D[Action according to 'post screening policy']
        D --> E[Reject]
        D --> F[Alert]
        D --> G[Accept]
        E --> H[Freeze the funds within deposit address]
        F --> I[Add event to the Audit-log]
        G --> I
        I --> J[AML passed successfully. Funds are available to spend]
    end
    Blockchain_node_1[Blockchain node] -.-> A
    B -.-> AML_Provider[AML Provider]
    B -.-> C
    C -.-> AML_Provider
    AML_Provider -.-> C
    C -.-> D
    D -.-> Blockchain_node_2[Blockchain node]
    D -.-> Fireblocks_component[Fireblocks component]
    D -.-> Third_party_service[3rd party AML service]
```

The flowchart illustrates the Fireblocks AML service process. It begins with a 'Blockchain node' sending data to the 'Fireblocks AML service' to 'Scan the blockchain for inbound transactions to Fireblocks addresses'. If AML is enabled on the workspace, the process moves to 'Screen according to screening policy'. This step involves sending transaction details to an 'AML Provider' and pulling for results. Once results are received, the system takes 'Action according to post screening policy', which can result in 'Reject' (freezing funds), 'Alert' (adding to audit log), or 'Accept' (allowing funds to be spent). The process also involves a 'Blockchain node', 'Fireblocks component', and a '3rd party AML service'.

- <https://support.fireblocks.io/hc/en-us/articles/360014290380-AML-Transaction-Screening-Monitoring>

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- Amount
- Origin address
- Beneficiary address
- Blockchain hash

4. Your AML provider determines the transaction's risk score and sends the result to your Fireblocks workspace. [Learn how Fireblocks handles incoming transactions when risk scores are not available immediately.](#)
5. The integration approves or rejects the transaction based on its risk information and your Post-Screening Policy.

You can configure your Post-Screening Policy so that you receive alerts when the transaction's risk information becomes available from your AML provider. After the screening, recorded information can be viewed in the Transaction History, the Audit Log, and your provider's interface for auditing by your compliance team.

Screening statuses

The screening status informs you of the status of Fireblocks' screening of your transaction.

- **Completed:** Screening has been completed successfully, meaning a successful result has arrived or the 6-hour timeout has been reached.
- **Pending:** Screening is still in progress. Transactions may have this screening status for up to 6 hours after registration with the transaction monitoring provider.
- **Bypassed:** Screening did not occur and the transaction was automatically accepted due to one of the following reasons:
 - **Policy:** If the Transaction Screening Policy defines the transaction to pass screening.
 - **Unsupported Asset:** Assets that are not supported by the provider.
 - **Unsupported Route:** [Some routes](#) are not supported for screening.
 - **Bypassed Failure:** If the screening process failed, it may indicate that your API Key is expired. By default, transactions with a screening failure are bypassed. If you want to freeze transactions when a screening failure occurs, you need to turn off the **Bypass on Failure** flag.
 - **Manual:** When a user manually bypasses a transaction's rejection using the Fireblocks Console or the Fireblocks API.
- **Failed:** Screening failure. Only possible when **Bypass on Failure** is turned off.

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- **Vault(s) ⇒ Vault(s)**
- **Vault(s) ⇒ Exchange(s)**
- **Gas Station ⇒ Vault(s)**
- **Non-custodial wallet(s) ⇒ Non-custodial wallet(s) in the same workspace**

For **Vault(s) ⇒ Vault(s)** and **Vault(s) ⇒ Exchange(s)**, withdrawal pre-screening is unsupported, but the transaction is still registered with the provider after it is sent.

Warning

Although these transactions bypass pre-screening, they are still registered with your AML provider (Chainalysis or Elliptic) and count toward your usage quota.

To prevent these transactions from being registered with your provider, configure your Transaction Screening Policy to **PASS** for **Vault(s) ⇒ Vault(s)** and/or **Vault(s) ⇒ Exchange(s)**. This ensures they bypass screening entirely and are not counted against your quota.

Note

When using Chainalysis V2, SOL transactions with an amount of 0.0 will bypass screening with a status of **Unsupported Route**.

Unsupported assets

Fireblocks does not support screening for non-fungible tokens (NFTs). Transactions that include NFTs will fail with a status of **Unsupported Asset**.

For developers

Want to integrate directly using the Fireblocks API? Learn more about [Transaction Screening for developers](#).

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-  Transaction screening operations
-  Global Policy: How Fireblocks ensures OFAC sanctions compliance
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